DAY 22 OF 30

Who can see what?

Security in Fabric, layer by layer.
From the workspace down to the row.

- Roles
- Permissions
- OneLake security

Keshav Maheshwari
Data Engineer | Databricks · AWS & Azure · Streaming · Applied AI

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THE PROBLEM

One platform means one place to get it wrong.

1	**Before**	Each tool had its own access list
2	**Now**	Many tools, one copy of the data
3	**The risk**	Access granted in one, open in all

When everything shares the same data, **a careless permission travels further**.

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THE SIMPLE VERSION

Keys to a building.

Some people get a key to the whole building. Some get one room. Some may only look through a window into one cabinet.

Fabric works in the same layers: **workspace, item, then the data inside**.

✓ **Workspace role**	A key to the room
✓ **Item permission**	A key to one cabinet
✓ **Data security**	Which drawers you may open

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HOW IT WORKS

The layers, from wide to narrow

1. **Microsoft Entra ID** proves who you are
2. **Workspace roles**: Admin, Member, Contributor, Viewer
3. **Item permissions**: share one lakehouse or report
4. **OneLake security**: tables, folders, columns and rows

Least privilege
Start people at the narrowest layer that lets them do the job, and widen only when needed.

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FOR ENGINEERS

Details people get wrong

Viewer is not harmless

A Viewer can query data through SQL and reports, but gets no direct OneLake file access unless a role grants it.

Contributor sees everything

Admin, Member and Contributor can read all data in the workspace. Row-level rules do not hold them back.

OneLake security travels with the data

Roles defined on the data are enforced across Fabric engines, not only in one tool.

Use groups, not names

Assign roles to security groups. Individual assignments are impossible to audit later.

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THE HONEST PART

Workspace role or finer control?

ROLE IS ENOUGH

A small team that all sees the same data

Development workspaces

Everyone builds, nobody only consumes

GO FINER

Sensitive columns such as salary

Different regions see different rows

Consumers outside the build team

> **The catch:** the quickest fix for "I cannot see it" is making someone a Contributor. That one click bypasses every row and column rule you designed.

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FROM REAL WORK

Security on a real project

A people-analytics platform holding sensitive employee data.

1. **Role-based access control** decided who could reach the platform
2. **Row-level security** limited which employees each user saw
3. **Sensitive personnel data** stayed protected inside Fabric
4. **HR leaders** queried it through reports and an assistant

With employee data, **security is the first design decision**, not the last.

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SAVE THIS

Security in five lines

1. **Identity** first, through Entra ID
2. **Workspace roles** for builders
3. **Item permissions** for sharing one thing
4. **OneLake security** for tables, columns, rows
5. **Contributor and above** bypass fine rules

Tomorrow: Row-level security. Same report, different rows for each person.

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